

Ilya Fedorov - AI Engineering Director

CONTACT

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- Auckland, New Zealand
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SUMMARY

- Head of Engineering with 20+ years of experience across software engineering, team leadership, and technology strategy - currently shaping an AI-first engineering practice at an AI/ML company.
- Proven track record building high-performing engineering teams, establishing delivery predictability, and aligning technology execution with business strategy.
- Deep Microsoft stack and cloud-native experience (C# .NET, Azure, microservices) - built and shipped production systems across commercial, consulting, and public sector environments.
- Hands-on performance and line management: hiring, coaching, performance reviews, and the full people management lifecycle including the hard conversations.
- Pre-sales and consulting delivery experience - solutioning with clients, managing expectations, and delivering on commitments in billable, client-facing environments.
- Directed adoption of TDD, CI/CD, SCRUM, infrastructure as code, and agile at scale across distributed engineering teams.
- Experienced at operating at senior leadership and board level, improving delivery predictability, and driving alignment across Engineering, Product, Operations, and Customer Success.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mindhive - Head of Engineering

Feb 2025 - Present · full-time · AI/ML, industrial computer vision

AI/ML company delivering industrial computer vision solutions for automated grading, defect detection, and operational workflows.

Highlights

- Established engineering leadership structure, improving alignment, accountability, and team effectiveness.
- Designed and implemented a new delivery cadence to improve predictability and reduce disruption from reactive demand.
- Introduced structured intake, triage, and prioritisation across Engineering, Product, and Customer Success.
- Implemented engineering flow metrics, improving visibility of demand, delivery performance, and system constraints.

- Accelerated adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices to improve delivery effectiveness.
- Lead engineering across software, platform, and ML delivery in a globally distributed startup (NZ, Brazil, Europe).
- Contributed to SLT and board discussions on capacity, prioritisation, security posture, and organisational design.
- Supported shift toward a more productised and scalable operating model.
- Strengthened platform operations and follow-the-sun support capability, improving resilience.

Tech: AWS, Python, React.js, Angular.js, DataDog, JIRA, Confluence

Tradify - Senior Software Engineering Manager

Dec 2023 - Feb 2025 · full-time · SaaS, field service management

High-growth SaaS platform for trades businesses, scaling rapidly across international markets.

Highlights

- Led multiple engineering teams, aligning delivery with product strategy and scaling objectives.
- Initiated frontend modernisation (AngularJS → React), defined the zero-downtime migration approach, and established the foundation before transitioning out of the role.
- Introduced flow metrics across engineering and product, enabling data-driven delivery decisions.
- Transitioned performance management to continuous feedback, improving engagement and development.
- Identified and resolved systemic platform misuse, reducing spamming incidents by ~75%.
- Established structured initiatives to reduce technical debt and improve system health.
- Strengthened engineering culture, increasing psychological safety and team effectiveness.
- Acted as a key interface between engineering and senior leadership.

Tech: React, AngularJS

Te Kete Hono - Head of Technology

May 2020 - Oct 2024 · contract · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact enterprise backed by Hugh Green Foundation, delivering 3 SaaS products to 20,000+ users across the education sector.

Highlights

- Built and led a high-performing engineering team of 6, establishing a technology governance framework across 3 SaaS products.
- Improved customer satisfaction by transitioning to microservice architecture, improving average response times by 30% and by 75% during peak hours.
- Planned and executed infrastructure modernisation and migration to Azure, reducing operational costs by 50%.
- Implemented Secure Development Life Cycle practices and passed an external security audit with zero risks reported and 100% compliance rating achieved.
- Orchestrated the on-time and under-budget launch of an ed-tech product, utilising agile methodologies to reduce time-to-market by 25%.

- Developed strategic technology vision and 3-year rolling development roadmap aligned with business objectives.
- Managed stakeholder and board relationships to ensure efficient development, implementation, and maintenance of systems.
- Articulated the product story, value proposition, and roadmap to external stakeholders; explained system architecture and technical foundations to due diligence participants.
- Supported the board in the sale of the business to a new entity.

Tech: C# .NET, Azure Functions, Entity Framework, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, React, JavaScript ES6, Webpack Module Federation, Jest, React Testing Library, SonarCloud

Serko - Software Engineering Manager

Aug 2019 - Apr 2020 · contract · Corporate travel and expense management, SaaS

Technology company offering intelligent corporate travel and expense solutions, controlling more than 70% of the corporate travel market in New Zealand and Australia.

Highlights

- Built a tightly knit team of 6 developers and created a safe, open culture to stimulate collaboration across 5 teams.
- Coached developers, promoted knowledge sharing, increased performance of the team by 50% through pair programming and mobbing.
- Reduced error rates on critical pathways by 90%.
- Guided teams to stabilise the product - created visibility of production issues, removed the fear of deployment, raised the maturity of development practices, and improved code quality.
- Facilitated shifting company-wide culture from startup to scale-up mentality, realigning team structure to product and business objectives.
- Promoted TDD, CI/CD, infrastructure as code, shifting quality left, pair and mob programming, SCRUM.
- Reviewed solution design against technical vision and redirected delivery teams; conceived strategies to counter product technical debt.
- Created architecture proposals and communicated them within the organisation.

Tech: C# .NET, Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, SQL Server, App Insights

Propellerhead - Product Owner / Development Manager

Oct 2017 - Nov 2019 · contract · Digital consultancy

Digital consultancy helping businesses make pragmatic and cost-efficient technology decisions, managing clients across government, commercial, and startup sectors.

Highlights

- Delivered multiple client engagements across government, commercial, and startup sectors - identity migration, MVP delivery, learning platforms, video streaming prototype.

- Liaised with client stakeholders to define product vision and product roadmap, and communicated progress toward it.
- Managed expectations and coordinated deliverables with 10 vendors.
- Guided 3 teams in different locations.
- Developed product architecture and technical vision, and communicated both within the organisation and to clients.
- Improved delivery team quality through the establishment and maintenance of technical practices.
- Reviewed solution design against technical vision and directed delivery teams accordingly.

Tech: Azure, AWS, C# .NET, React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, Cosmos DB, MySQL, MongoDB, Auth0

Schooltalk - Co-founder / Software Engineering Manager

Jan 2015 - Sep 2017 · co-founder · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact startup that developed a software platform to help teachers track student progress, monitor engagement, and assess achievement.

Highlights

- Co-founded and built a SaaS platform from concept to production.
- Secured funding through grants and stakeholder engagement.
- Built and led engineering capability, introducing agile practices.
- Created and conducted end-user and pre-sales presentations.
- Interviewed and hired new team members.

Tech: C#, ASP.Net MVC 5, Azure App Services, AWS Lambda, React.js, SQL Server, Azure Blob Storage

Fraedom.com - Senior Full-Stack Software Developer

Apr 2013 - Jan 2015 · full-time · FinTech, expense management

Technology partner of VISA providing Total Transaction Management solutions.

Freightways - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Nov 2007 - Mar 2013 · full-time · Logistics and courier services

New Zealand courier and logistics company operating NZ Couriers, DX Mail, Post Haste, Pass the Parcel, and Castle Parcels.

Thor United - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Feb 2006 - Nov 2007 · full-time · Investment and financial services

Investment company based in Russia/USA.

Nicotech International - Analyst-Programmer

Apr 2005 - Oct 2005 · full-time · Software development

| *Software house.*

Sportmaster - Analyst-Programmer

Sep 2001 - Apr 2005 · full-time · Retail, sportswear

| *Leading sportswear retailer in Russia.*

EDUCATION

- Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and Computer Science - Auckland University of Technology
- Postgraduate Diploma in Business Analysis - Russian Academy of National Economy
- Master of Applied Physics and Mathematics - Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & COMMUNITY

- Executive Coaching with Noah Cantor (2024-present)
- Executive Coaching with Paul Birch (2025-present)
- Founded and facilitate a peer forum of engineering leaders (Canva, Gentrack, Fintfox) focused on scaling teams, delivery systems, and leadership effectiveness
- Mentor at University of Auckland Chiasma programme
- Chair, local VEX V5 robotics club supporting homeschooled students in competitive robotics (2026)